

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 8 5
♥ K 7
♦ 9 7 4 3
♣ 8 7 2

♠ A 10 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ A Q 10 2

♣ Q 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 6 4

♥ Q J 10 5 3

♦ 8 5

♣ A 10 4

♠ K 7 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ K J 6

♣ K J 9 5

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

you play low. Declarer will love you. He will hold up on the ♥Q, then again on trick two when you play the ♥K. AND HE WILL STILL HAVE HIS ♥A when you switch to another suit. He will have time to drive out the ♣A while he still has ♥s stopped.

It was a good thing you held the ♥K rather than declarer, but it is a nuisance that you must get out of the way on the very first trick.

[showcards W:HQ N:H4]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥Q, dummy played the ♥4

Play the ♥K.

Admittedly you have a terrible hand. But that's no reason to be careless. **YOU** can beat this contract, but you have to do it right now by unblocking the ♥K. If declarer holds up you will continue with your ♥7 and partner will establish his suit while he still has the ♣A for an entry. If declarer doesn't hold up it will be just as bad for him.

But suppose you say "Well, partner's ♥Q is just as good as my ♥K so I'll just save the King for later" as

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q J 10 7

♥ A 5

♦ K 4 2

♣ A J 2

♠ K 6 2

♥ K Q 3

♦ 10 9 8 5

♣ 9 7 3



♠ 5 4

♥ 10 8 7 4

♦ Q J 6

♣ K 6 5 4

♠ 9 8 3

♥ J 9 6 2

♦ A 7 3

♣ Q 10 8

West

1 ♠

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

North

Pass

East

1NT

South

Pass

[showcards W:H2 N:HA]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥2, dummy played the ♥A

Play the ♥Q (or ♥K).

You know partner has a 4-card ♥ suit, (he led the deuce), and you know it is headed by an honor. You hope the honor is the ♥J, but in any case you must get your high ♥s out of the way.

Declarer will probably come to his hand and then take a ♠ finesse. You win the ♠K, take your other high ♥, then lead your ♥3 toward your partner.

As you see, partner did hold the ♥ J 9, so your side wins 3 ♥ tricks.

If declarer played low on the first trick you would win the ♥Q, then play the ♥K to dummy's ♥A.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 6 5

♥ A K 3

♦ Q 7 2

♣ 8 4 2

♠ K 9 2

♥ Q 10 9 8 5

♦ A 6

♣ A 10 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 7

♥ 6 4 2

♦ 10 9 8 5

♣ 9 7 3

♠ Q 4 3

♥ J 7

♦ K J 4 3

♣ K Q J 5

West

North

East

South

1♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

South will take the ♠Q at trick 1, but when West wins a high ♥ he will play another ♠ through dummy's ♠ K 9 to your ♠ A J. Once you clear dummy's ♠ away partner will win another ♥ and be able to cash his last ♠.

[showcards W:S5 N:S2]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠5, dummy played the ♠2

Play the ♠7.

Partner's low ♠ lead tells you he has an honor in the suit, so it must be either the ♠Q or the ♠10. South's jump to 2NT makes it almost certain that he holds the ♠Q, so you can figure partner probably led from ♠ 10 x x 5.

Apply the Rule of 11. 11 minus 5 = 6 cards higher than the ♠5 held by dummy, you, and declarer.

Since you can see 5 of the 6 you conclude that that declarer will have to play his ♠Q to beat your ♠7.

Note that if dummy's ♠9 was played you would cover with your ♠J, leading to the same situation.